

Verité Family Tree Editor

Complete Operations & User Reference Manual

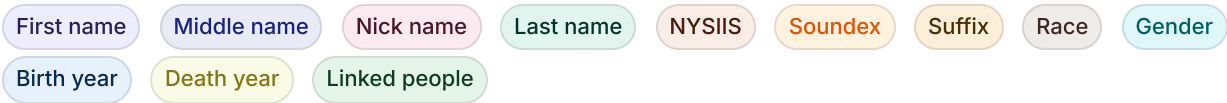
1. INTRODUCTION & LAYOUT STRUCTURE

Verité is an advanced desktop-style genealogical software designed for visual family tree modeling, data alignment, and matching profiles against historical documents/mentions. The workspace is divided into two primary columns:

- **Left Column (Family Tree Canvas):** An SVG canvas using D3 force-directed layout to display family nodes. Male nodes are colored blue, female nodes are orange, and gender-neutral nodes are circular. Relationships are rendered as directed edges.
- **Right Column (Detail Editors):** A dynamic tabbed interface:
 - **Person Editor:** Controls details, data integration rules, and source configurations for the selected individual.
 - **Mentions Editor:** Reviews, evaluates, and merges scored matching document records into the selected tree profile.
 - **Sources:** Hosts an interactive search portal to query available database archives.

2. FIELD COLOR CODES & MEANING

Verité uses a consistent, harmonic color scheme throughout the application to visually link variables and parameters. The color badges for individual data factors are:



3. MENU REFERENCE & FILE EXPORTS

The top menubar provides typical desktop options:

- **File Menu:**
 - **New:** Reset canvas and start a blank tree workspace.
 - **Export > GEDCOM:** Export the current tree structure to the industry-standard GEDCOM format for import into other family tree applications.

- **Export > RDF:** Export the tree as graph database Resource Description Framework (RDF) triples.
- **Edit Menu:**
 - **Undo (`ctrl+Z`):** Step backward through node placements and changes.
 - **Redo (`ctrl+Y`):** Step forward through undone changes.
 - **Add person:** Creates a new related node connected to the active node.
 - **Remove person:** Delete selected person and remove their relationship connections.
- **View Menu:** Includes canvas zoom controls, Fit to Screen, Reset Layout, and toggles the Notepad.

4. MATCHING & SCORING RULES

A. The Blocking Step

Before any similarity scores are computed, candidates must pass hard constraints. A mention is filtered out immediately if:

- It does not belong to the selected list of search sources.
- Its gender does not match the target profile.
- Its race does not match the target profile (if race comparison is enabled).
- The mention source year and the target birth year differ by more than 75 years (chronological check).

B. Smart Name Cascade (When Smart Name Checked)

Smart Name evaluates names as a collective group, taking into account common nicknames and phonetic overlays. It runs the following priority check:

1. Exact match on first, middle, and last name: **1.00**
2. Exact match on first and last name: **0.95**
3. Exact match on initials or normalized nickname: **0.90**
4. Jaro-Winkler above threshold on first and last names: **0.70**
5. Phonetic sound match via NYSIIS: **0.60**
6. Phonetic sound match via Soundex: **0.50**

C. Individual/Year Factor Scoring

If Smart Name is off, name fields are scored individually based on settings (Exact = 1.0, Fuzzy Jaro-Winkler = JW score). Chronological year fields are scored via band matching (ScoreYear):

Year Distance	±1 yr Option	±2 yrs Option	±3 yrs Option	±5 yrs Option
Exact Match	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0
1 year off	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8
2 years off	0.0	0.7	0.7	0.7
3 years off	0.0	0.0	0.6	0.6
5 years off	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.5

5. LINKING RECORDS & PROFILE VERIFICATION

- **Scored Mention List:** Mentions tab displays candidates ordered by overall score. Click any mention to inspect details.
- **Merging Details:** Review individual fields in the comparison grid. The bottom box shows original JSON data stored on the server.
- **Link a Mention:** Clicking **Add to person** merges the record's mention ID into the tree profile.
- **Verity Star Display:** The verity indicator (1-4 stars) visually reflects the statistical likelihood/confidence rating of the profile representation.

6. RESIZABLE NOTEPAD & TOOLS

The Notepad allows persistent research notes. To open it, click **View > Notepad**. You can drag it by its header and drag its bottom/sides to resize. Its contents are saved to the project data automatically.